
VALI MIKHO REAL ESTATE

The Seller *Playbook*

How a home is prepared, launched and negotiated across Hamilton, Burlington and the Golden Horseshoe. What happens at each stage, and what it asks of you.

How to use this playbook

Selling a home is a sequence of decisions, most of them made before the listing ever goes live. This document sets out that sequence so you know what is coming, what each stage asks of you, and where you have a genuine choice to make.

Dates are deliberately absent. Every property prepares at a different pace and every market moves differently, so preparation and launch timing are agreed with you rather than fixed to a template. What follows is the order of events, not a calendar.

A NOTE ON OUTCOMES

Nothing in this playbook promises a sale within a particular period or at a particular price. What it does promise is that you will understand each decision before you make it, and that you will see the market response as it happens rather than after the fact.

The four stages

STAGE	WHAT IT COVERS
Preparation	Valuation, pricing approach, condition and presentation
Launch	Photography, marketing assets, going live
Market Response	Showings, feedback, and adjusting together
Offers and Closing	Negotiation, conditions, and the path to firm

Preparation

Most of the outcome is determined before a buyer ever sees the property. This stage is where the work pays off.

1

Establish what the property is worth

Recent comparable sales are reviewed, weighted for condition, lot, exposure and finish. Active competing listings matter as much as solds, because those are what a buyer will see alongside your home.

2

Agree a pricing approach

There is more than one valid strategy and they behave differently. Pricing to invite competition, pricing at market, and pricing above market each carry trade-offs in speed, leverage and final result. We discuss which suits your situation and your timeline.

3

Decide what is worth improving

Some work returns more than it costs and some does not. The recommendation is specific to your property: what buyers in your price band expect, what will show poorly in photographs, and what is better disclosed than fixed.

4

Prepare the home

Decluttering, minor repairs, cleaning and light staging, scheduled around your availability. Trades are coordinated where needed.

WHAT YOU PROVIDE

Access for trades and photographers, decisions on recommended work, and any documents you hold: surveys, permits, warranties, recent utility costs and renovation receipts.

Launch

The launch date is chosen with you. There is no fixed number of days between agreement and going live.

5

Capture the property properly

Professional photography, video walkthrough and floor plans, shot once the home is genuinely ready. Photographs are the first showing and most buyers decide from them whether to book a second.

6

Build the listing

Listing copy written for the property rather than assembled from stock phrases, with the features that matter to the buyer most likely to want it.

7

Pre-market outreach where it suits

For some properties, advance notice to the agent network and to buyers already looking in your area creates early momentum. For others it does not help. This is discussed rather than applied automatically.

8

Go live

The listing publishes to the MLS System and syndicating portals, supported by paid social and email to the local network.

WORTH UNDERSTANDING

The first two weeks generally attract the most attention a listing will receive. That is why preparation is finished before launch rather than during it.

Market Response

Once live, the property starts producing information. This stage is about reading it accurately and acting on it together.

9

Monitor the response

Showing requests, online views and saves, open house attendance, and what visiting agents say afterwards. All of it is tracked from the first day.

10

Report it to you regularly

You receive the actual numbers and the actual feedback, including the unflattering comments. Buyer objections repeat, and the repetition is the useful part.

11

Adjust the approach as needed

If response is below expectation we discuss why and agree what changes. Price is one lever. Photography, access hours, staging, listing copy and marketing channels are others, and often the more useful ones.

HOW TO READ THE SIGNALS

Views but few showings usually points at price or presentation in the photographs.

Showings but no offers usually points at something buyers encounter in person: condition, layout, or a value gap against competing homes.

Neither views nor showings usually points at price relative to the competing inventory.

Offers and Closing

Offers are reviewed and negotiated as they arrive. Price is one term among several.

12

Review each offer in full

Price, conditions, deposit size, closing date and any inclusions. A higher price with weak financing and a long condition period can be worth less than a lower, cleaner offer.

13

Negotiate

Counter, accept or decline, with the reasoning explained each time. Where several offers arrive together, each is assessed on the same terms so the comparison is genuine.

14

Work the conditions

Condition and closing deadlines follow the accepted agreement, not a generic schedule. Each date is tracked and the buyer side is chased so nothing lapses quietly.

15

Reach firm and close

Conditions waived, lawyers coordinated, final walkthrough arranged and keys handed over on the closing date set in the agreement.

IF CONDITIONS ARE NOT MET

A deal can fail at the condition stage. If it does, the property returns to market and the earlier feedback informs what changes. This happens, and it is not a reason to accept unfavourable terms out of caution.

Seller checklist

Work through these as each stage comes up. Nothing here needs doing all at once.

Before listing

- ☐ Evaluation completed and pricing approach agreed
- ☐ Recommended improvements decided and scheduled
- ☐ Decluttering and deep clean completed
- ☐ Documents gathered: survey, permits, warranties, utility costs
- ☐ Mortgage discharge terms and any penalty confirmed with your lender
- ☐ Real estate lawyer engaged

At launch

- ☐ Photography, video and floor plans completed
- ☐ Listing copy reviewed and approved by you
- ☐ Showing access and lockbox arrangements agreed
- ☐ Plan for pets, children and valuables during showings

While on market

- ☐ Property kept showing-ready
- ☐ Feedback reviewed with Vali regularly
- ☐ Adjustments discussed and agreed as needed

Once sold

- ☐ Conditions tracked to their deadlines
- ☐ Lawyer has the agreement and your identification
- ☐ Movers booked and utilities scheduled for transfer
- ☐ Keys, remotes, manuals and spare fobs gathered for handover

Answered honestly

Should I price high and come down later?

It is an option, and it has a cost. Overpriced listings attract the least attention during the window when attention is highest, and a price reduction later signals weakness to buyers watching days on market. If you want to test a higher number we can, provided you go in understanding the trade-off.

How long will it take to sell?

That depends on price, preparation, season and competing inventory, and no honest answer exists before the property is on market. What can be said is that well-prepared homes priced to the market tend to sell materially faster than the alternative.

Do I need to stage?

Full staging is not always necessary. Light staging of key rooms, or simply editing what is already there, often does most of the work. The recommendation depends on the property and how it photographs.

What if I get an offer immediately?

An early offer is not automatically a problem, though it does deserve scrutiny. We review the terms rather than the timing, and if the offer is strong there is rarely merit in waiting for a hypothetical better one.

What are my costs as a seller?

Typically real estate commission, legal fees, any mortgage discharge penalty, and moving costs. Adjustments for prepaid taxes or utilities may apply. Exact figures depend on your property and your lawyer.

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